

# IS THIS THE METAVERSE?

ARE WE ALREADY LIVING IN A VIRTUAL WORLD?

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**A**ll the talk thus far, has been about us heading into the metaverse. It's mostly about VR and us blurring the lines between reality and the metaverse. But is that the right way to look at the metaverse? Is that definition of the metaverse too narrow and limiting, and is it the line being pushed by those with VR company stock to sell?

If we look at the metaverse as a small universe where individuals go to connect and have shared experiences, then is pretty much every service a metaverse? Is YouTube a metaverse? Let's examine that...

YouTube has its own set of creators and viewers, and that is a very big set of people indeed. They have their own little niches, and their own little interests and collaborations, which mimic a different community. This could be the music listening and creating community, where the creators vie for eyeballs. It could be a science loving community where Veritasium is king. It could be our own YouTube community that hardly any of you follow, because we're still under 3 lakh subscribers! Seriously, go to [youtube.com/digit](https://youtube.com/digit) and subscribe to our channel already!

What we're saying is that YouTube is made up of thousands of smaller communities and interests all exactly like we would expect in a metaverse. If you took YouTube, made it into a huge city, where all channels were

buildings and all videos were rooms inside those buildings. Then you had all of us users walk about as avatars exploring the city, it would create a city that's larger and more populated than any city on earth. This is because there are 37+ million youtube channels. The entire population of the state of Delhi is 31 million people, imagine if every person in Delhi had their own building, how big a city would it need to be? Remember, not family, every single person owning their own building, some with thousands of rooms in them!

Now imagine Facebook, Instagram, Twitter, etc all being metaverses. Fortnite and Roblox and games like that could be considered metaverses, also games like No Man's Sky, which is literally a universe worth of planets to explore...

## WE HAVE AVATARS

Even the concept of avatars is not new. We all have them for various purposes, either for use in games, or using them for personalised GIFs, making a Wii profile, whatever! In fact, most of us have phones capable of rendering avatars on top of our faces in real-time, so we can record videos as avatars in case we don't want to reveal our face or don't like the way we look.

The metaverse concept is the idea that we can be who we want to be, and immerse ourselves into a virtual world. We don't even need avatars for that. Just take a look at the absolute fakery on social media and you will see that people's lives are obviously

nothing like they make them appear to be. Instagram is especially plagued with this need to make everything look good and surreal, people using a tonne of filters only to hashtag their post as #NoFilter. We've all been to the same places these instagram influencers go, and they just don't look like that. Forget that, even the influencers themselves don't look the way they photoshoot themselves.

What we're saying is that we already lead a double life, or at least a heck of a lot of us do. We make our achievements seem bigger than they are, we put so much icing on everything that one forgets that there is supposed to be cake as well below!

If living our dreams in an imaginary world is the definition of the metaverse, then we're already doing that on social media!

## THE METAVERSE EXPERIENCE

Instead of trying to sell you on the concept, we figured it would be better to break down the metaverse experience into little buckets and then you can decide for yourself if you've been living in that way already.

### Addictive

There has got to be a draw to the metaverse. It has to be something you experience and then keep getting pulled back into. After all, if it's going to cost us money to be able to enter the metaverse, we will need it to pay back the experience, right? We've got to crave it when we're not using it, feel lost without it, and be willing to pay money to use it. Does any of this sound familiar?

### Ever-changing

Another aspect has got to be a constant upgrade cycle, not just of the hardware we buy, but the experiences we get. That's how a lucrative market is created, which then forces innovation and improvement of all aspects of the experience. We started with it needing to be addictive, because that's the baseline we need, which then incentivises us to spend more money on upgrading once every year or two. It is what allows the experience to be